

24STCV01333 24STCV01333

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 407

Hearing date: 2026-07-21

Source URL:

https://www.lacourt.ca.gov/tentativeRulingNet/ui/main.aspx?casetype=civil&dept_date=LAM%2C407%2C07%2F21%2F2026

Source SHA-256: 9f1914b4c01ed8f9524a0cc5b02472978b920acea52dd3fe0177416e994887b7

Case Number: 24STCV01333 Hearing Date: July 21, 2026 Dept: 407

Tentative Ruling

Judge Brock T. Hammond, Department 407

HEARING DATE: July

21, 2026 TRIAL

DATE: August 31, 2026

CASE: Cynthia Ramirez v. Prestige Media Group, Inc.

CASE NO.: 24STCV01333

PLAINTIFF'S

MOTION TO COMPEL DEPOSITION OF

DEFENDANT

PRESTIGE MEDIA GROUP INC.'S OWNERS

PLAINTIFF'S

MOTION TO COMPEL DEPOSITION OF

DEFENDANT

PRESTIGE MEDIA GROUP INC.

MOVING PARTY: Plaintiff

Cynthia Ramirez

RESPONDING PARTY: No opposition

I. INTRODUCTION

On May 21 and June 11, 2026, Plaintiff, Cynthia Ramirez, filed these motions to compel defendant Prestige Media Group, Inc. ("PMG") to appear for deposition and to produce its owners, defendants Alexandra Vershinina ("Vershinina") and Sergey Vershinin ("Vershinin"), to appear for deposition. Plaintiff requests sanctions.

The motions are unopposed.

II. LEGAL STANDARD

Any party may obtain discovery by taking in California the oral deposition of any person. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2025.010.) "If, after service of a deposition notice, a party to the action...without having served a valid objection under Section 2025.410, fails to appear for examination, or to proceed with it, or to produce for inspection any document, electronically stored information, or tangible thing described in the deposition notice, the party giving the notice may move for an order compelling the deponent's attendance and testimony, and the production for inspection of any document, electronically stored information, or tangible thing described in the deposition notice." (Code Civ. Proc., § 2025.450(a).)

Monetary Sanctions

Code of Civil Procedure section 2023.030 is a general statute authorizing the Court to impose discovery sanctions for "misuse of the discovery process," which includes (without limitation) a variety of conduct such as: making, without substantial justification, an unmeritorious objection to discovery; making an evasive response to discovery; and unsuccessfully and without substantial justification making or opposing a motion to compel or limit discovery. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2023.010.)

If sanctions are sought, Code of Civil Procedure section 2023.040 requires that the notice specify the identity of the person against

whom sanctions are sought and the type of sanction requested, that the motion be supported in the points and authorities, and the facts be set forth in a declaration supporting the amount of any monetary sanction. 222222

2

"If a motion under [Code of Civil Procedure section 2025.450] subdivision (a) is granted, the court shall impose a monetary sanction under Chapter 7 (commencing with Section 2023.010) in favor of the party who noticed the deposition and against the deponent or the party with whom the deponent is affiliated, unless the court finds that the one subject to the sanction acted with substantial justification or that other circumstances make the imposition of the sanction unjust." 2 (Code Civ. Proc., § 2025.450, subd. (g)(1).) 222222

III. DISCUSSION

There is no dispute that Plaintiff properly served notices to take Defendants' depositions. Defendants failed to assert timely objections to those notices. It is further undisputed that Defendants failed to appear for their depositions. (See Jones Decls.) Plaintiff is therefore entitled to the requested order. The court will grant the motions.

Monetary Sanctions

Plaintiff requests sanctions against Defendants. Based on Plaintiff's filings in connection to this matter, as well as the court's ruling to grant the motions, the court finds sanctions against Defendants are warranted. Accordingly, sanctions are imposed against each defendant in the sum of \$1,500, for a total sanctions award of \$4,500.

IV. CONCLUSION

The unopposed motions are GRANTED. Defendants are ordered to appear for deposition within 15 days of this order.

Each defendant is ordered to pay sanctions in the sum of \$1,500, for a total sanctions award of \$4,500, within 30 days of this order.

Plaintiff

is ordered to give notice, unless waived.

Dated: July 21, 2026

Brock T.
Hammond

Judge of
the Superior Court